

Creditors

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Defined.

Philemon 18 If he hath wronged thee, or oweth thee ought, put that on mine account;

MIGHT DEMAND

Pledges.

Deuteronomy 24:10-11 When thou dost lend thy brother any thing, thou shalt not go into his house to fetch his pledge. 11 Thou shalt stand abroad, and the man to whom thou dost lend shall bring out the pledge abroad unto thee.

Security of others.

Proverbs 6:1 My son, if thou be surety for thy friend, if thou hast stricken thy hand with a stranger,

Proverbs 22:26 Be not thou one of them that strike hands, or of them that are sureties for debts.

Mortgages on property.

Nehemiah 5:3 Some also there were that said, We have mortgaged our lands, vineyards, and houses, that we might buy Corn, because of the Dearth.

Bills or promissory notes.

Luke 16:6-7 And he said, An hundred measures of oil. And he said unto him, Take thy bill, and sit down quickly, and write fifty. 7 Then said he to another, And how much owest thou? And he said, An hundred measures of wheat. And he said unto him, Take thy bill, and write fourscore.

To return before sunset, garments taken in pledge.

Exodus 22:26-27 If thou at all take thy neighbour's raiment to pledge, thou shalt deliver it unto him by that the sun goeth down: 27 For that is his covering only, it is his raiment for his skin: wherein shall he sleep? and it shall come to pass, when he crieth unto me, that I will hear; for I am gracious.

PROHIBITED FROM

Taking millstones in pledge.

Deuteronomy 24:6 No man shall take the nether or the upper millstone to pledge: for he taketh a man's life to pledge.

Violently selecting pledges.

Deuteronomy 24:10 When thou dost lend thy brother any thing, thou shalt not go into his house to fetch his pledge.

Exacting usury from Brethren.

Exodus 22:25 If thou lend money to any of my people that is poor by thee, thou shalt not be to him as an usurer, neither shalt thou lay upon him usury.

Leviticus 25:36-37 Take thou no usury of him, or increase: but fear thy God; that thy brother may live with thee. 37 Thou shalt not give him thy money upon usury, nor lend him thy victuals for increase.

Exacting debts from Brethren during sabbatical year.

Deuteronomy 15:2-3 And this is the manner of the release: Every creditor that lendeth ought unto his neighbour shall release it; he shall not exact it of his neighbour, or of his brother; because it is called the LORDS' release. 3 Of a foreigner thou mayest exact it again: but that which is thine with thy brother thine hand shall release;

Might take interest from strangers.

Deuteronomy 23:20 Unto a stranger thou mayest lend upon usury; but unto thy brother thou shalt not lend upon usury: that the LORD thy God may bless thee in all that thou settest thine hand to in the land whither thou goest to possess it.

Sometimes entirely remitted debts.

Nehemiah 5:10-12 I likewise, and my Brethren, and my servants, might exact of them money and Corn: I pray you, let us leave off this usury. 11 Restore, I pray you, to them, even this day, their lands, their vineyards, their oliveyards, and their houses, also the hundredth part of the money, and of the Corn, the wine, and the oil, that ye exact of them. 12 Then said they, We will restore them, and will require nothing of them; so will we do as thou sayest. Then I called the priests, and took an Oath of them, that they should do according to this promise.

Matthew 18:27 Then the lord of that Servant was moved with compassion, and loosed him, and forgave him the debt.

Luke 7:42 And when they had nothing to pay, he frankly forgave them both. Tell me therefore, which of them will love him most?

Often cruel in exacting debts.

Nehemiah 5:7-9 Then I consulted with myself, and I rebuked the nobles, and the rulers, and said unto them, Ye exact usury, every one of his brother. And I set a great assembly against them. 8 And

I said unto them, We after our Ability have redeemed our Brethren the Jews, which were sold unto the heathen; and will ye even sell your Brethren? or shall they be sold unto us? Then held they their peace, and found nothing to answer. 9 Also I said, It is not good that ye do: ought ye not to walk in the fear of our God because of the reproach of the heathen our enemies?

Job 24:3-9 They drive away the Ass of the Fatherless, they take the widow's ox for a pledge. 4 They turn the needy out of the way: the poor of the earth hide themselves together. 5 Behold, as wild asses in the desert, go they forth to their work; rising Betimes for a prey: the wilderness yieldeth food for them and for their children. 6 They reap every one his Corn in the field: and they gather the vintage of the wicked. ...

Matthew 18:28-30 But the same Servant went out, and found one of his fellowservants, which owed him an hundred pence: and he laid hands on him, and took him by the throat, saying, Pay me that thou owest. 29 And his fellowservant fell down at his feet, and Besought him, saying, Have Patience with me, and I will pay thee all. 30 And he would not: but went and cast him into prison, till he should pay the debt.

OFTEN EXACTED DEBTS

By selling the debtor or taking him for a Servant.

Matthew 18:25 But forasmuch as he had not to pay, his lord commanded him to be sold, and his wife, and children, and all that he had, and payment to be made.

Exodus 21:2 If thou buy an Hebrew Servant, six years he shall serve: and in the seventh he shall go out free for nothing.

By selling the debtor's property.

Matthew 18:25 But forasmuch as he had not to pay, his lord commanded him to be sold, and his wife, and children, and all that he had, and payment to be made.

By selling the debtor's family.

2 Kings 4:1 Now there cried a certain woman of the wives of the sons of the Prophets unto Elisha, saying, Thy Servant my husband is Dead; and thou knowest that thy Servant did fear the LORD: and the creditor is come to take unto him my two sons to be bondmen.

Job 24:9 They pluck the Fatherless from the breast, and take a pledge of the poor.

Matthew 18:25 But forasmuch as he had not to pay, his lord commanded him to be sold, and his wife, and children, and all that he had, and payment to be made.

By imprisonment.

Matthew 5:25 Agree with thine adversary quickly, whiles thou Art in the way with him; lest at any time the adversary deliver thee to the Judge, and the Judge deliver thee to the officer, and thou be cast into prison.

Matthew 18:34 And his lord was wroth, and delivered him to the tormentors, till he should pay all that was due unto him.

From the sureties.

Proverbs 11:15 He that is surety for a stranger shall smart for it: and he that hateth suretiship is sure.

Proverbs 22:26-27 Be not thou one of them that strike hands, or of them that are sureties for debts. 27 If thou hast nothing to pay, why should he take away thy bed from under thee?

Were often defrauded.

1 Samuel 22:2 And every one that was in distress, and every one that was in debt, and every one that was discontented, gathered themselves unto him; and he became a captain over them: and there were with him about four hundred men.

Luke 16:5-7 So he called every one of his lord's debtors unto him, and said unto the

first, How much owest thou unto my lord? 6 And he said, An hundred measures of oil. And he said unto him, Take thy bill, and sit down quickly, and write fifty. 7 Then said he to another, And how much owest thou? And he said, An hundred measures of wheat. And he said unto him, Take thy bill, and write fourscore.

ILLUSTRATIVE OF

God's claim upon men.

Matthew 5:25 Agree with thine adversary quickly, whiles thou Art in the way with him; lest at any time the adversary deliver thee to the Judge, and the Judge deliver thee to the officer, and thou be cast into prison.

Matthew 18:23 Therefore is the Kingdom of Heaven likened unto a certain king, which would take account of his servants.

Matthew 18:35 So likewise shall my heavenly Father do also unto you, if ye from your hearts forgive not every one his brother their trespasses.

The demands of The Law.

Galatians 5:3 For I testify again to every man that is circumcised, that he is a debtor to do the whole law.